

Samsung SV0401H

Quiet data access

Samsung's latest VL40 series hard drive is a compact version of the old V40 series. PC users are often dissatisfied with 20 GB hard drives, and look for upgrades. For home users, speed less important than capacity, and many will find this 5400 rpm, 40 GB drive acceptable.

The hard drive was tested with a 2.8 GHz Pentium 4 processor, 512 MB Kingston DDR 333 SD RAM, a GeForce3 graphics card and a 40 GB IBM Deskstar primary hard drive. The drive to be tested was connected as the secondary master with Ultra DMA enabled for faster access.

The SV0401H has a low CPU utilisation of 2.3 per cent, which prevents strain and leaves the processor free for other tasks.

The random read and write speeds are pretty good, making it an ideal choice for hard disk intensive applications, such as PhotoShop. In the SiSoft Sandra benchmark, it clocked a good sequential read speed of 25 MBps and write speed of 24 MBps, for a home user. The disk gave an average drive index score of 17334. If

you want to transfer large amounts of data, you should consider a 7200 rpm drive.

This drive is a good entry-level buy as it is very silent and comes with a three-year warranty. It will suffice for Internet browsing, word processing and database management.



Price: Rs 4,350
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SPECIFICATIONS
0.67 x 4 x 5.75 inches, 0.55 Kg, 5400 rpm, ATA 100 interface, 2 MB buffer, 512 Bytes per sector

Samsung SV0401H		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

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McAfee VirusScan Home Edition 7.0

Fortify your PC

The latest McAfee VirusScan Home Edition includes many new features, such as HAWK (Hostile Activity Watch Kernel), that runs in the background and monitors activity on your PC. We tested it on a Pentium 4 2.0 GHz processor on an Intel D845GEBV2 motherboard, 128 MB DDR SDRAM and a 40 GB Seagate ST340016A hard disk drive.

It scans e-mails for viruses, worms, scripts and other mali-

cious code, while remaining up-to-date by automatically downloading the latest virus definition files. A good feature is the inclusion of a firewall—McAfee Guardian. This firewall gives detailed information regarding the Internet activity on your machine. It comes with an easy to use wizard called Configuration

Assistant, which lets the user set up the firewall in just five small steps. Switching between the

